Geoff Nitschke

Design Researcher & Applied Anthropologist

geoff.nitschke@example.com 082 555 0139 12 Jacaranda Avenue, Germiston, 1401 Portfolio

Professional Summary

I'm a design researcher and applied anthropologist with over five years of experience uncovering customer needs across African markets, particularly in fintech and digital services. I blend qualitative and quantitative methods to surface insights that drive product and service innovation. With a strong leadership foundation, I've guided cross-functional teams, mentored junior researchers, and facilitated workshops that align stakeholders around customer experience improvements.

Experience

Senior UX Researcher, Umoja Bank

Aug 2024 – Current, Cresta – Randburg (Hybrid)

- Led end-to-end customer research to uncover key insights into user needs, expectations, and pain points, directly informing strategic improvements to digital customer journeys.
- Received formal recognition for leading a high-impact research project on a Retirement Planner and Financial Wellness Dashboard, contributing to improved customer understanding and product alignment with user financial goals.
- Facilitated usability testing across diverse customer segments, identifying systemic issues and recommending enhancements that improved ease of use and satisfaction.
- Championed a customer-first mindset by delivering clear, actionable reports that influenced product and service design across teams.
- Identified simplification opportunities within research operations and processes.

UX Researcher, StreamSphere

Sep 2022 – Aug 2024, Ferndale – Randburg (Hybrid)

- Collaborated with designers and product managers to conduct qualitative and quantitative research across customer-facing platforms — including StreamSphere Live, CineWave, and the MyStream app — to enhance end-to-end customer journeys.
- Provided research recommendations to improve accessibility, content discoverability, streamline onboarding flows, and prioritize features that align with user viewing habits and digital preferences across web, mobile and leanback platforms.

UX Researcher, AfriUX Collective

April 2022, Remote / Dakar

- Contracted with a pan-African UX research team to conduct remote user tests in South Africa to understand the perceptions and usability of various payment apps in Sub-Saharan Africa.
- Researched and monitored emerging fintech innovations across African markets to stay current on trends, technologies, and customer behavior shaping the startup landscape.

Skills

- Engaging and influencing executives and decision-makers to align design research with business goals.
- Driving user-centric culture through mentoring and embedding research practices.
- Leading user interviews, surveys, and journey mapping to uncover customer needs.
- Facilitating cross-functional workshops to co-create user-centered solutions.

Tools

- Hotjar
- Amplitude
- Lookback.io
- Dovetail
- Optimal Workshop

Affiliations

Selected as a fellow for the inaugural 2023 cohort of the Applied Ethnography in Industry Community (AEIC), an international community dedicated to advancing ethnographic research in applied industry settings globally.

References

Elna Venter
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Thabiso Molefe
UX Researcher
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UX Designer, BrightSpark Digital

Jan 2020 – Aug 2022, Sandton (Hybrid)

- Contributed to the redesign of the SafeGuard Life website by developing wireframes and prototypes aligned with user needs — resulting in a 17% drop in bounce rate, a 25-second increase in session duration, and a 1.5% lift in conversion above KPIs.
- Collaborated on UX research for clients like FlameGrill and SafeGuard Life, supporting the development of test scripts, moderating usability sessions, and synthesizing insights into actionable reports.
- Designed an internal performance management system adopted by 200+ employees, improving usability and task efficiency for HR and team leads.
- Completed a certified UX internship, where I conducted a full UX case study using human-centered design methods and developed a detailed customer journey map to inform design strategy.

Education

Bachelor of Arts, Honours Degree, Cultural Anthropology

Dec 2019, Johannesburg City University

Grade: Achieved a 72.8% average.

Dissertation: Examined the role of hairdressers as key cultural agents, both constrained by and contributing to the transformation of aesthetic and social norms in contemporary South Africa.

Bachelor of Arts, Specialising in Social Science

Dec 2018, Johannesburg City University

Completed with specialization in Social Science.

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